Knowledge organiser (SUMMIT) — Analysing curated spaces and audience impact

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do curatorial choices — scale, lighting angle, sightlines, and framing — shape audience meaning in an exhibition?

Core studio focus

Family: Studio suite

Big question: How do curatorial choices — scale, lighting angle, sightlines, and framing — shape audience meaning in an exhibition?

• Analyse how directional lighting (raking side light vs flat front light) transforms 3D relief artwork.

• Evaluate exhibition case studies across four curatorial variables: Sightline height, Spatial grouping, Lighting angle, and Interpretation.

• Test directional lighting on your own structural relief panel and produce an annotated Curatorial analysis & Lighting plan.

Essential vocabulary

• raking light: A directional light source shone across a surface from a low side angle to throw every bump and recess into deep shadow.

• curatorial intent: The deliberate mood and visual journey a curator designs through spacing, height, and lighting.

• juxtaposition: Placing two artworks side by side so their scales, textures, or forms highlight each other.

• interpretation panel: The wall text and labels that frame the context and technical process for visitors.

• spatial hierarchy: Using central placement, breathing space, and spotlights to signal key focal works.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Run a live raking-light test on my panel: I hold a directional lamp at 90 degrees (flat) and 25 degrees (raking top-left) to my Week 3 relief panel and observe the shadow shift.

Step 2: Draw the two lighting diagrams and patina highlights: I sketch a comparative lighting diagram on my Curatorial board, then skim dry chrome/chalk along the top-left flanges of my panel to lock in that raking light.

Step 3: Draft the Curatorial space & Audience analysis: I complete my four-part analysis evaluating how lighting, sightlines, grouping, and wall text shape viewer engagement.